

KIIT and KISS have hosted numerous important tournaments, setting a benchmark in sports excellence. These institutions have successfully organized prestigious events, including the FIFA Football for Schools Programme, the KISS FIVB Volleyball Foundation Festival, the 1st Khelo India University Games, the 25th All India Forest Sports Meet, and the first-ever Janjatiya Khel Mahotsav in 2023. Over the years, KIIT and KISS have nurtured 21 Olympians, 3 Paralympians, 11 Arjuna Awardees, and 1 Khel Ratna Awardee, along with 5000+ athletes who have brought glory to India at the Olympics, Asian Games, Commonwealth Games, and various other international and national championships.



KIIT and KISS are nodal centers for the FIFA Football for Schools Programme and the FIVB Volleyball for All Programme in South Asia. KIIT received the Rashtriya Khel Protsahan Puruskar 2022 from the Government of India. The institutions have been awarded the Sportstar Award (2022, 2025), FICCI India Sport Award, CII Sports Business Award (2023), and Biju Patnaik Award for sports promotion. Prof. Achyuta Samanta was awarded the FIVB Grand Cross, the highest honor in volleyball, recognizing his grassroots promotion of the sport in India including the term when he was the president of Volleyball Federation of India. KIIT and KISS have been chronicled in Guinness World Records for the largest volleyball exhibition match in 2024.

Prof. Samanta has played a key role in fostering sports like Rugby, Kho-Kho, and Chess in Odisha, helping KIIT & KISS, as well as the state and country, gain

global recognition in hosting these sports. KISS is the only institution in India to integrate Chess into its academic curriculum. It is also an associate sponsor of Rugby India. Both KIIT & KISS have also aimed at making Sports more inclusive by establishing 10 sports academies for talented sportspersons in and around Odisha. The institutions have also introduced sports in rural areas. Every year around 1.5 lakh sportspersons, coaches and managers come to KIIT and KISS to participate in the various tournaments and training camps hosted by the institutions.

Believing in the philosophy that investing in youth and sports is investing in the future, he aspires to double all stadiums and sports complexes seeing the fruits of his work. If more institutions adopt this model of right support that can turn talent into champions, India's rise in the global sporting arena will be unstoppable.

